SOLAR ACCELERATOR

7-Day Sales Rep
Certification Program

DAY 6

Advanced Objection Mastery & Deal Rescue

Modules 6.1–6.10 · Anatomy of Resistance · ACAC · Smoke Screens · Deal Rescue · Hostile Homeowners · Certification

Deconstruct Every Objection. Rescue Every Deal. Become the Master of Resistance.

MODULE 6.1

The Anatomy of Resistance: Why They Say 'No'

The Neurobiology of Sales Resistance — and How to Defuse It

MODULE 6.1 — ANATOMY OF RESISTANCE

It's Not Personal. It's Neurological.

1. The Amygdala Hijack: when the lizard brain overrides the logical brain
2. Fear of Regret (FOR): the most powerful objection in solar isn't price
3. Contractor Trauma: how past horror stories contaminate the current consultation
4. Safety Framing: making homeowners feel safe enough to tell you the truth

The Amygdala Hijack: When the Lizard Brain Takes Over

- When a homeowner sees a $40,000+ proposal, the brain's threat-detection system fires — this is biological, not personal
- Signs of the Hijack: crossed arms, shortened breath, backward lean, one-word answers, sudden 'bathroom break'
- The Hijack is a response to perceived RISK — not to solar, not to you, not to the price
- Response: slow down, lower your voice, stop adding information — let the amygdala settle before re-engaging

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Understanding the Amygdala Hijack gives reps permission to not take resistance personally. When a homeowner shuts down, the rep's instinct is to talk more and faster — the opposite of what the biology requires. Slow is pro.*

Fear of Regret (FOR): The Hidden Objection That Kills Deals

- The #1 objection in solar is NOT price — it is the fear of looking stupid to their spouse, family, or neighbors
- The Internal FOR: 'What if this is a scam and I signed?' — social humiliation risk
- The External FOR: 'My brother-in-law is going to say I got ripped off' — audience risk
- Counter: 'I completely understand — every smart person who cares about their family thinks about this. Here's how we make sure you're covered no matter what.'

DIALOGUE

Rep:
Can I be honest with you? A lot of people in your position worry about one thing: what happens if they say yes and then someone — a friend, a family member — second-guesses the decision. Is that part of what's in the back of your mind?
Homeowner:
Yeah... honestly, kind of.
Rep:
That's the smartest thing you could be thinking about. Let me show you exactly how to answer that person when they ask.

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: FOR is invisible until you know to look for it. When a homeowner seems intellectually convinced but still won't sign, FOR is almost always present. Validate the social risk explicitly — don't pretend it doesn't exist.*

The Contractor Trauma Trap

- Many homeowners have been burned by roofers, HVAC companies, or other home service contractors — and solar looks like more of the same
- Signs of Contractor Trauma: hyper-focus on the contract terms, questions about what happens 'if you go out of business,' reluctance to let workers on their roof
- Response: acknowledge it explicitly — 'You've been burned before by a contractor. I want to address that directly.'
- Radical Transparency: show them the cancellation policy, the manufacturer warranty, the BBB rating — proactively, before they ask

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The rep who proactively surfaces Contractor Trauma builds 10x more trust than the one who waits for the homeowner to bring it up nervously. 'I want to address the elephant in the room' signals confidence, not defensiveness.*

Safety Framing: Making the Homeowner Feel Safe Enough to Be Honest

❌ UNSAFE ENVIRONMENT (Rep Behavior)

- Jumps to rebuttals before fully acknowledging
- Uses pressure phrases: 'This offer expires today'
- Gets louder or faster when challenged
- Dismisses concerns with data before validating
- Shows any sign of desperation or frustration

✅ SAFE ENVIRONMENT (Rep Behavior)

- Labels the fear before offering the solution
- Uses the Late Night DJ voice — slow, warm, confident
- Pauses after objections — lets silence do the work
- Invites honesty: 'Tell me what's really on your mind'
- 'If this doesn't make sense for you, I'll tell you'

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Psychological safety is the single biggest lever in the closing environment. Homeowners who feel safe tell the truth. Homeowners who don't feel safe tell you what they think will get you out of the house fastest.*

🎯 ACTIVITY

Activity: The Fear Map Exercise

OBJECTIVE: Categorize every reason a homeowner might be afraid to sign — and prescribe the antidote

1. Each rep writes down 10 reasons a homeowner would be afraid to sign right now
2. Categorize each fear as: LOGICAL (data can solve it) or EMOTIONAL (validation must come first)
3. For each Emotional fear, write a one-sentence 'Safety Frame' that acknowledges it without defending against it
4. Share the top 3 with the group — which fears are most universal in your market?
5. Deliverable: A written 'Empathy Opener' script for homeowners who show signs of Contractor Trauma

30 MIN

MODULE 6.2

The ACAC Framework: The Universal Objection Handler

4 Steps. Every Objection. Every Time.

MODULE 6.2 — THE ACAC FRAMEWORK

Acknowledge → Clarify → Address → Confirm

1. Acknowledge: the Cushion that prevents the argumentative tone
2. Clarify: asking 'What specifically?' instead of defending
3. Address: Feel-Felt-Found and Third-Party Proof methods
4. Confirm: the Close-Back that kills the 'Zombie Objection'

The ACAC Framework: 4 Steps, Every Objection, Every Time

A Acknowledge

The Cushion

- 'I hear you — if I were in your position I'd think the same thing'
- Never skip this step
- Lowers defense before logic lands
- Buys time to think before responding

C Clarify

The Deep Dive

- 'When you say [X], what specifically do you mean?'
- Find the exact fear, not the surface statement
- Avoid assuming — ask first
- One question, then stop talking

A Address

The Solution

- Feel-Felt-Found: 'Others felt the same — here's what they found'
- Third-party proof: data, reviews, filings
- Don't over-explain — one clear solution
- Match solution to the clarified fear

C Confirm

The Close-Back

- 'Does that fully clear that up for you?'
- Kill the Zombie Objection before moving on
- If not resolved: re-clarify, don't re-defend
- Small 'Yes' = green light to advance

Step 1 — Acknowledge: The Cushion Technique

- 'I hear that — and honestly, if I were sitting in your seat, I'd be thinking the exact same thing'
- The Cushion is not agreement — it is empathy. You are validating their right to feel that way.
- Critical rule: never go to Step 2 (Clarify) before Step 1 (Acknowledge) is visibly received
- Signs the Cushion landed: uncrossed arms, audible exhale, eye contact returns, 'Yeah... exactly'

DIALOGUE

Homeowner:
I just don't trust solar companies.
Rep (wrong):
We've been in business 12 years and have an A+ BBB rating—
Rep (right):
You know what? That's a completely fair way to feel. The industry has some real bad actors. If I hadn't personally seen what this does for families, I'd probably feel the same way. Can I ask — is it the industry in general, or something specific you've heard?

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The Cushion is the single most skipped step in sales, and its absence is the single biggest reason objections escalate into arguments. A rep who never skips the Cushion will close significantly more deals than one who is technically superior but impatient.*

Step 2 — Clarify: The 'What Specifically?' Pivot

- 'When you say the price is high — are you comparing it to what you expected, or to what you're already paying the utility?'
- 'When you say you want to think about it — is it the math, the company, or the timing that needs more thought?'
- 'When you say it seems risky — what's the specific risk you're most worried about?'
- Rule: ask one clarifying question, then stop. Do not add more questions or data before they answer.

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Most objections are umbrellas covering multiple specific fears. Clarifying questions identify which fear is actually present. 'The price is high' can mean: I can't afford it, I think I can find it cheaper, or the monthly payment scares me. Each requires a completely different Address.*

Step 3 — Address: Feel-Felt-Found + Third-Party Proof

- Feel-Felt-Found: 'I understand how you feel. Other homeowners have felt exactly the same way. Here's what they found after going ahead.'
- Third-Party Proof: 'Don't take my word for it — here's the Google review from a family in your neighborhood who had the same concern'
- One clear solution only — multiple solutions signal desperation and reopen the objection
- Match the solution type to the fear type: Logical fears → data. Emotional fears → social proof + validation.

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Feel-Felt-Found works because it removes isolation — the homeowner is no longer the only person who has felt this way. Third-Party Proof works because external voices carry more credibility than anything the rep says.*

Step 4 — Confirm: The Close-Back That Kills Zombie Objections

- 'Does that fully clear that up for you, or is there still a question there?'
- A Zombie Objection = one that was 'answered' but not actually resolved — it comes back at the worst possible moment
- If their answer is 'mostly' or 'I guess' — they are still in the Clarify phase. Re-ask. Do not advance.
- A clean 'Yes, that makes sense' is the only green light to move forward

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The Confirm step is the most powerful close in objection handling — and the most skipped. Reps feel uncomfortable asking if the objection was truly resolved because they fear the answer is 'not really.' But that fear costs deals. The Zombie Objection that isn't confirmed kills the close at the worst possible moment.*

ACAC in Action: 5 Real Objections, Full Framework

🚩 HOMEOWNER SAYS	✅ REP RESPONDS (ACAC)
'Solar is just too new — I don't trust the technology'	**Cushion → 'What specifically concerns you — panel reliability or company longevity?' → Feel/Felt/Found + NREL data → 'Does that ease the technology concern?'**
'My roof might need replacing in 5 years'	**Cushion → 'Is the roof issue about timing or cost?' → Present roof lease/wait options → 'Does knowing we can time the install around the roof help?'**
'I've seen bad reviews about solar online'	**Cushion → 'What review specifically — about us or the industry?' → Show live reviews + BBB → 'Does what you're seeing on our profile change that picture?'**
'I don't think I use enough electricity to make it worth it'	**Cushion → 'Is the concern about current usage or future rates?' → Show 25-year inflation projection → 'Does the future rate picture change the math for you?'**

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Walk reps through each objection twice: once using ACAC correctly, once jumping straight to Address without Acknowledge or Clarify. Let them feel the difference in how the homeowner responds to each approach.*

🎯 ACTIVITY

Activity: ACAC Speed Drills

OBJECTIVE: Deliver the Acknowledge and Clarify steps for any objection in under 10 seconds

30 MIN

1. Trainer throws an objection — rep has exactly 10 seconds to deliver A + C only
2. No addressing, no data, no defense — just a perfect Cushion and one Clarifying question
3. Round 2: Trainer confirms the clarified concern — rep delivers A + C + A + C (full framework) in 45 seconds
4. Partner grades: Did the Cushion feel genuine or robotic? Did the Clarify question actually narrow the concern?
5. Deliverable: Completed ACAC Worksheet for the 5 most common objections in your local market

MODULE 6.3

Identifying the Smoke Screen vs. The Fire

Stop Solving Problems That Don't Exist

MODULE 6.3 — SMOKE SCREENS

Find the Real Objection Under the Polite Excuse

1. The Isolate Move: 'Aside from [X], is there anything else holding you back?'
2. The Magic Wand Question: testing if the stated objection is actually the real one
3. Peeling the Onion: asking 'Why?' three levels deep to find the root cause
4. The 3 Isolation Questions every rep uses in every consultation

The Smoke Screen: What It Is and Why Homeowners Use It

- A Smoke Screen is a polite, face-saving excuse used to avoid disclosing the real fear
- Common Smoke Screens: 'We need to talk to our accountant,' 'We want to research more,' 'The timing isn't right'
- The real fears behind the smoke: price anxiety, distrust of the rep, distrust of the company, spousal conflict
- Rule: Never argue with the Smoke Screen — that's arguing with a symptom, not treating the disease

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The hardest part of the Smoke Screen concept for reps to accept is that the homeowner isn't lying maliciously — they're being polite. Once reps understand this, they stop getting defensive about the smoke and start getting curious about the fire.*

The Isolate Move: Clearing the Smoke

- After any soft objection, always ask: 'Aside from [that concern], is there anything else that's holding you back from moving forward?'
- If they say 'No, that's the main thing' — you have isolated the real objection and now have something specific to solve
- If they say 'Well, also...' — you have found additional fires that would have burned the deal after the smoke was cleared
- The Isolate Move prevents the 'infinite objection loop' where solving one surfaces another

DIALOGUE

Rep:
I hear you on the accountant piece — that's smart. Aside from getting the accountant's input, is there anything else that would keep you from moving forward?
Homeowner:
Well... honestly, we're also not 100% sure we trust solar companies in general.
Rep:
I'm really glad you said that — that's the more important thing for us to talk about. Can I address that directly?

The Magic Wand Question: Testing the Smoke Screen

- Use when you suspect the stated objection is a cover story: 'If I could wave a magic wand and [solve that exact thing] right now — would you be ready to go solar today?'
- If 'Yes' → the stated objection is real — solve it completely
- If 'No' or 'Maybe' → the stated objection is a Smoke Screen — ask what else is present
- If 'I don't know' → they are in the Fear Gap — return to the emotional safety conversation

DIALOGUE

Homeowner:
We just need to talk to our accountant before we do anything this big.
Rep:
Totally fair. Let me ask you something though — if I could guarantee right now that the tax credit works exactly the way I showed you, and the accountant signed off today, would you be ready to move forward?
Homeowner:
Hmm... I think there's also the question of whether we really want panels on the roof.
Rep:
There it is. Tell me more about that.

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The Magic Wand question is disarming because it's hypothetical and playful. It removes the pressure of the actual decision while revealing whether the objection is real or a polite stall. Deliver it with a smile — it should feel curious, not confrontational.*

Peeling the Onion: 3 Levels Deep to the Root Cause

1 **Level 1 — The Surface Statement** 'The price is too high.' → This is the polite version. Do not address this directly.

2 **Level 2 — The Clarified Fear** 'So when you say high — is it the monthly payment or the total number that concerns you?' → 'The total number looks scary.'

3 **Level 3 — The Root Cause** 'And when you look at that total number — what specifically worries you about it?' → 'I'm nervous about my job situation next year.'

4 **The Real Close** Now you have the actual fear: 'What if I lose my job?' — which has a completely different solution than 'the price is high.'

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The Onion technique takes 90 seconds and saves 30 minutes of misdirected rebuttals. Most reps never get past Level 1. The rep who reaches Level 3 consistently is operating in a completely different league.*

🎯 ACTIVITY

Activity: Smoke or Fire Roleplay

OBJECTIVE: Use isolation questions to find the hidden objection behind a polite stall

30 MIN

1. Partner A plays a homeowner with a HIDDEN objection (written on a card — not shown to the rep)
2. Partner A uses a Smoke Screen to deflect: 'We just want to talk to our accountant'
3. Partner B (rep) uses: Isolate Move → Magic Wand → Peel the Onion until the card's hidden objection is identified
4. Hidden objection examples: 'I don't believe the savings are real,' 'My wife doesn't want strangers on the roof,' 'I think the company will go bankrupt'
5. Deliverable: Each rep writes down 3 'Isolation Questions' they will use in every consultation from now on

MODULE 6.4

Advanced 'Think About It' Mastery

From Thinking to Deciding — Without Pressure

MODULE 6.4 — ADVANCED THINK ABOUT IT

The Most Expensive Word in Solar: 'Later'

1. The Permission to Be Frank Frame: turning the stall into a coaching conversation
2. The Thinking Cost Calculator: quantifying the daily penalty of delay
3. The Calendar Lock: never leave without knowing the real status
4. A 2-minute recorded response to 'We need to think about it'

The Permission to Be Frank Frame

- When a homeowner stalls, ask for permission to be direct: 'Can I be totally honest with you for a second?'
- 'Usually, when someone tells me they need to think about it, it means I missed something in my explanation. What did I not cover well enough?'
- This reframe puts the rep in the 'humble advisor' role — not a defensive salesperson
- It also surfaces the real concern by making the homeowner feel responsible for helping, not just escaping

DIALOGUE

Rep:
Can I be totally honest with you for a second? Usually when someone says they need to think about it, it means I didn't explain something clearly enough. What was the part that I didn't cover well?
Homeowner:
No, no — you explained everything well. It's just... we're not sure if now is the right time financially.
Rep:
I really appreciate you saying that. Financial timing is exactly what I should have addressed more directly. Can I show you one more thing on that before you go?

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: This is one of the most psychologically sophisticated techniques in the curriculum. When the rep takes responsibility for the stall ('I missed something'), the homeowner almost always corrects them: 'No, it's not you, it's just...' — and the real objection surfaces.*

The Thinking Cost Calculator: Quantify the Delay

- If the system saves $150/month, every day of 'thinking' costs the homeowner $5.00
- 'I'm not trying to pressure you — I just want to make sure you have all the numbers, including this one: every day we wait costs you about $5'
- Frame it as a missed opportunity, not a closing tactic: 'I'd feel terrible if you spent 2 weeks deciding and lost $70 in savings in the process'
- For high-bill homeowners ($300+/mo): the daily cost is $10+ — this number lands very hard

DIALOGUE

Rep:
I want to be transparent about something before we wrap up. At your bill level, every day between now and when your system starts producing costs you about $8 in savings you'll never recover. That's not pressure — it's just math I want you to have. Over 2 weeks of thinking, that's $112 in permanent lost savings. I'm not saying that to rush you — I just want to make sure you factor that in.
Homeowner:
Huh. I didn't think about it that way.

The Calendar Lock: Never Leave Without a Status

- A 'follow up next week' with no locked date or agenda is a dead lead — reps must classify every appointment at close
- The Final Question: 'Before I go — on a scale of 1–10, how likely is it that we're going to do this together?'
- A 7 or above: lock a specific callback or signature date — 'Can we put Tuesday at 6pm in both our calendars right now?'
- Below a 7: ask 'What would move that number up?' — this surfaces the final hidden objection

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The Calendar Lock prevents the rep from driving away telling themselves 'they're probably going to do it' when the deal is actually dead. Honest pipeline intelligence is more valuable than comfortable ambiguity.*

🎯 ACTIVITY

Activity: The Thinking Debate

OBJECTIVE: Pitch why 'thinking about it' is the most expensive thing a homeowner can do

30 MIN

1. Each rep must deliver a 2-minute argument — in character, to a real person — for why thinking costs more than deciding
2. Must include: the daily cost calculation, the inflation clock, and the lost incentive risk
3. Cannot use pressure language: no 'limited time,' no 'this offer expires,' no manufactured scarcity
4. Partner judges: Did this feel like information or pressure? Did it use the homeowner's actual bill number?
5. Deliverable: A recorded 2-minute audio response to 'We need to think about it' — submit for manager review

MODULE 6.5

Defeating the 'More Quotes' Comparison

Stop Being a Commodity. Start Being the Standard.

MODULE 6.5 — MORE QUOTES

The Buyer's Checklist: Setting the Rules of Engagement

1. The Comparison Standard: providing the criteria before they shop
2. The Value of Time frame: more quotes have a real, compounding cost
3. The Expert vs. The Bidder: service and certainty as the premium
4. Creating a homeowner checklist that happens to favor your offer

The Comparison Standard: Control the Criteria

- Before they can meaningfully compare, help them understand what they should be comparing
- Give them a 'Solar Buyer's Checklist' — 5 questions every homeowner should ask every company
- Design the checklist to highlight your company's actual strengths (workmanship warranty, monitoring, roof penetration coverage)
- Offer to help them evaluate other quotes when they come in: 'I'll even help you compare — I have nothing to hide'

DIALOGUE

Rep:
I completely support you getting other quotes. Before you do, I want to give you something that will make that process a lot more useful. Here are the 5 things that actually separate a quality solar installation from a cheap one. When you get other quotes, use this — and I promise it'll make the comparison easier.
Homeowner:
Oh. I hadn't thought about asking for all of this.
Rep:
Most people don't. That's exactly how the cheap guys get in the door.

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The rep who provides the comparison framework becomes the trusted advisor, not just another bidder. When the homeowner evaluates competitors through YOUR criteria, your offer wins almost by definition — as long as your criteria are genuinely relevant.*

The 5-Point Solar Buyer's Checklist

- 1. Workmanship Warranty: How many years? Does it cover roof penetration damage specifically?
- 2. Post-Install Monitoring: Who monitors the system performance? Is it included in the price or an add-on?
- 3. Manufacturer vs. Installer Warranty: If the installer goes out of business, who backs the product warranty?
- 4. Production Guarantee: Is there a guaranteed annual output in kWh — or just an estimate?
- 5. Emergency Response Time: If a panel fails or the system goes down, what is the guaranteed response time?

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Laminate this checklist and give it to every homeowner who says they want more quotes. The questions are calibrated to expose the weaknesses of budget competitors. When they come back from 3 other quotes, they'll have the answers — and yours will compare favorably.*

The Value of Time Frame: More Quotes Have a Real Cost

- 'How many hours of your time are you willing to spend to potentially save $5 a month?'
- Getting 3 quotes takes: 3 evenings of appointments (6+ hours) + research time + comparison time
- 'Meanwhile, your utility bill is running at $280 a month — and every week of comparison shopping is another week of no savings'
- The Incentive Clock: 'Net metering changes and tax credits don't announce when they're changing — they just change'

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Use this frame only with genuine conviction — if there are real incentive windows closing, say so. If not, stick to the time-cost argument. Manufactured incentive urgency destroys trust the moment the homeowner discovers it was false.*

🎯 ACTIVITY

Activity: The Checklist Creation Exercise

OBJECTIVE: Build a homeowner-facing comparison checklist that positions your company as the benchmark

25 MIN

1. Each rep creates a 5-point 'Solar Buyer's Checklist' using their company's real strengths
2. Each point must be phrased as a question the homeowner asks the competitor — not a statement about your company
3. Test: If a competitor answered all 5 questions as well as your company does, would you still win? If not, revise.
4. Role-play: Deliver the checklist to a partner playing a homeowner who wants 3 more quotes
5. Deliverable: A personalized 'Why Us' comparison sheet for the field folder

MODULE 6.6

Taming the 'Analytical Owl'

From Spreadsheets to Signatures

MODULE 6.6 — THE ANALYTICAL OWL

Feed the Data Hunger Without Drowning in It

1. Feeding the Owl with limits: satisfying the analytical need without enabling infinite questions
2. The Decision Criteria Agreement: locking the question set before the deep dive
3. The Bottom Line pivot: every technical answer ends in a financial outcome
4. The Tech-to-Cash drill: 45 seconds from spec to dollar impact

Identifying and Feeding the Owl (With Limits)

- The Owl's strength: they will research everything and buy confidently when satisfied
- The Owl's trap: they use data requests as a stall — 'I just have a few more questions' never ends
- Feed them data at a high level first, then pivot to the FINANCIAL IMPACT: 'Inverter efficiency is 98% — which means for you, every drop of sun becomes a dollar'
- Always add the phrase: 'Does that answer the technical piece, or would you like me to go deeper on the specs?'

DIALOGUE

Homeowner:
Can you tell me about the degradation rate of these specific panels?
Rep:
Good question. These panels degrade at about 0.5% per year — which is best-in-class. In practical terms, that means in year 25 your system is still producing at 87.5% of Day 1 output. Which means the savings I showed you are actually conservative. Does that put the degradation question to bed, or would you like me to pull up the spec sheet?

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The 'Would you like me to go deeper?' question is a trap set with permission. If they say 'yes,' you're about to satisfy a real analytical need. If they hesitate, they were stalling — and now they know you know.*

The Decision Criteria Agreement: Lock the Question Set

- Before the technical deep dive, ask: 'What are the 3 things you need to see today to feel 100% confident moving forward?'
- Write them down visibly — 'I want to make sure I hit all three before we're done'
- This prevents the Infinite Question loop: 'You said three things — we've covered all three. Are we at 100% confidence?'
- If they add a 4th question after the 3 are covered: 'That's a great question — is this the last thing between you and moving forward?'

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The Decision Criteria Agreement is one of the most elegant closing techniques in existence. It turns an open-ended analytical conversation into a finite contract. When all three criteria are met, the rep has earned explicit permission to close.*

The Bottom Line Pivot: Every Tech Answer Ends in Dollars

- After any technical explanation, always end with: 'The bottom line for you is [dollar/financial impact]'
- N-Type cells → 'The bottom line: more power from less roof — your system fits your layout'
- Rapid shutdown → 'The bottom line: your family is safer, and your insurance company likes it'
- String inverter vs. microinverter → 'The bottom line: with your roof layout, this choice saves you $800 and performs equally well'
- Never leave a technical statement without a financial landing point

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The Bottom Line pivot is a habit reps must build until it's automatic. Any technical conversation that ends on a spec — not a dollar — has failed. The homeowner remembers the dollar. They forget the spec.*

🎯 ACTIVITY

Activity: Tech-to-Cash Roleplay

OBJECTIVE: Answer any technical question and pivot to the financial impact in under 45 seconds

25 MIN

1. Trainer asks the most complex technical question they can think of (e.g., 'What is the temperature coefficient of these panels?')
2. Rep must: answer accurately at a high level → pivot with 'which means for you...' → land on a dollar outcome
3. Timer: if they can't land on a financial outcome in 45 seconds, restart
4. Round 2: rep delivers the Decision Criteria Agreement to an 'Owl' homeowner and locks 3 criteria
5. Deliverable: A 'Quick Facts' technical cheat sheet covering the top 8 Owl questions with a Bottom Line for each

MODULE 6.7

Rebuilding Trust: Handling Hostility & Skepticism

Flip the Hostile Homeowner Into a Brand Advocate

MODULE 6.7 — HOSTILE HOMEOWNERS

The Rep Who Stays Calm Gets the Sale

1. The Low Heart Rate Mastery: physiological tools for de-escalation
2. Joining the Resistance: agreeing with skepticism to defuse it
3. The Radical Transparency Close: negative framing that builds massive trust
4. Voice as a tool: the Late Night DJ under pressure

The Low Heart Rate Mastery: Staying Calm Under Fire

- Physiological reality: when attacked verbally, the body activates the same threat response as physical danger
- The rep's outward demeanor must be the OPPOSITE of their internal state — this is a trained skill
- Tools: box breathing before appointment, deliberate vocal slowdown during challenge, strategic pause after hostile statement
- The Late Night DJ voice: low, slow, warm — as if you are unshakable because you have nothing to hide

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Have reps practice delivering a calm response while the trainer reads hostile statements in an elevated voice. The contrast between the trainer's energy and the rep's calm is the exact dynamic they'll face in the field.*

Joining the Resistance: Agree With the Skepticism

- When a homeowner says 'Solar is a scam,' the worst response is any form of defense
- The right response: 'You're right to be skeptical. There are genuinely bad actors in this industry. That's exactly why I'm here — to show you how we're different.'
- Agreeing with the skepticism removes the adversarial dynamic — you are now on the same side
- Technique: 'I would have said the exact same thing 3 years ago' — this humanizes the rep and signals authenticity

DIALOGUE

Homeowner:
Honestly, solar feels like a giant scam to me. You guys just take the money and run.
Rep:
You know what? You're not wrong to think that — there are companies that do exactly that. If I had your experience, I'd feel the same way. That's why I want to be the most transparent person you've talked to today. Can I show you something that the bad actors would never show you?

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: 'Joining the Resistance' is one of the most counterintuitive techniques in the curriculum — and one of the most powerful. When the rep agrees that skepticism is warranted, the homeowner has nothing to push against. The argumentative energy dissipates.*

The Radical Transparency Close: Negative Framing That Builds Trust

- 'If this didn't make financial sense for your specific situation, I would be the first person to tell you to stop — my reputation in this community is worth more than one deal'
- Offer the DQ: 'Honestly, I want to make sure this is right for you — let me run through the two scenarios where solar is NOT a good fit, and you tell me if either applies'
- Show the fine print proactively: 'Here's the cancellation window, here's the production guarantee, here's what you do if there's a problem — I want you to see this before I ask for anything'
- The Boomerang: homeowners who try to disqualify themselves usually end up MORE committed when the rep doesn't push back

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Radical Transparency is the most advanced trust-building tool in the curriculum. It works because it is the exact opposite of what a dishonest company would do. Showing the worst case, the fine print, and the DQ criteria signals: 'I have nothing to hide.'*

Hostile Homeowner Response Matrix

🚩 HOMEOWNER SAYS	✅ REP RESPONDS (ACAC)
'Solar is a scam — I don't believe any of this'	**'You're right to be skeptical. Let me show you what separates us from the ones you've heard about.'**
'I had solar before and it was a nightmare'	**'I'm sorry that happened. Can I ask what specifically went wrong? I want to make sure we address that directly.'**
'You salespeople all say the same thing'	**'Fair. What would I need to show you that would prove I'm being straight with you?'**
'I've already done my research and I know solar is overpriced'	**'Great — then you'll be the perfect judge of whether what I'm showing you is competitive. What did you find?'**

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Each response uses agreement or curiosity — never defense. The moment a rep becomes defensive, they confirm the homeowner's suspicion that they have something to hide. Curiosity and agreement are the only weapons against hostility.*

🎯 ACTIVITY

Activity: The Angry Homeowner Gauntlet

OBJECTIVE: Maintain the Late Night DJ voice while being verbally challenged

30 MIN

1. Trainer reads hostile solar myths loudly and aggressively, one at a time: 'Solar causes fires,' 'Your company will be gone in 2 years,' 'I've seen 3 lawsuits against solar companies this year'
2. Rep must respond to each with: Join the Resistance → Clarify → Radical Transparency — all in a calm, measured voice
3. Evaluator watches for: any vocal pitch increase, any defensive body language, any defensive language
4. Rep 'passes' only when the trainer reduces their energy in response to the rep's calm
5. Deliverable: Recorded roleplay showing the de-escalation of a hostile homeowner — submit for review

MODULE 6.8

Deal Rescue: The Emotional Reset

Recover a Dying Deal Before It Walks Out the Door

MODULE 6.8 — DEAL RESCUE

When the Consultation Goes Sideways — Take Control

1. The Elephant in the Room Move: name the wall before it buries you
2. The Take-Away (Negative Close): let them chase the deal you're offering to remove
3. Revisiting Discovery: going back to 'Why' when the 'What' has stalled
4. The written 'Deal Rescue' script

The Elephant in the Room Move: Name the Wall

- When a deal is visibly stalling — longer silences, shorter answers, defensive body language — call it out
- 'I want to be straight with you — it feels like we've hit a wall somewhere. Can we take our sales hats off for a second and just talk?'
- 'Where did I lose you? I'd rather find out now than have you leave feeling like this didn't work'
- This move resets the emotional tone from transactional to human — it creates a genuine pause that often unlocks the real concern

DIALOGUE

Rep:
I'm going to be honest — I feel like we've hit a wall somewhere in the last 10 minutes, and I'd rather address it directly than pretend everything is fine. Where did I lose you?
Homeowner:
[pause] It's just... my wife isn't as sure as I am.
Rep:
That's important. Can I talk to both of you together for just 5 minutes about the specific thing she's worried about?

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The Elephant Move requires courage — most reps are afraid that naming the stall will confirm the deal is dead. The opposite is true. Homeowners who were quietly shutting down often reengage when a rep is brave enough to name what everyone feels.*

The Take-Away (Negative Close): Let Them Chase the Deal

- 'Honestly, Mr. and Mrs. Johnson — based on what you're saying, it sounds like solar might not be the right fit for you right now. And that's completely okay.'
- 'I'd rather you not do this and be happy with that decision than do it and have any regrets. Should we just table this for today?'
- The psychology: when a deal is offered and then removed, humans instinctively want what they can no longer have
- The Boomerang: most homeowners who were about to say no respond to the Take-Away by recommitting — often with the real objection now visible

DIALOGUE

Rep:
I want to be honest with you — I've been doing this long enough to know when the timing isn't right. It sounds like there are a few things that aren't quite lined up for you today. I'd rather pull the plug and let you think through it than push you into something you're not sure about. Does that make sense?
Homeowner:
Wait — no, I mean... we are interested. I think it's just the payment that's the sticking point.
Rep:
I'm glad you said that. Tell me more about the payment concern — is it the monthly amount or the total?

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The Take-Away is a high-risk, high-reward technique — only use it when the deal is already dying. It should feel genuine, not manipulative. The rep must be truly willing to let the deal go. If they aren't, the homeowner will smell the desperation and it will backfire.*

Revisiting Discovery: Go Back to the 'Why'

- When the close has stalled, return to the original pain from discovery
- 'Remember when you told me you were worried about your retirement income and these rate hikes? Is that concern no longer there, or did I just not show you how this solves it well enough?'
- This reconnects the emotional memory of the original pain to the current decision
- The technique assumes the rep took detailed discovery notes — which is why Day 3 emphasized writing everything down

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: The Revisit move is only powerful if the discovery was deep. A rep who took surface notes has nothing to return to. A rep who captured emotional pain, future goals, and specific fears has a powerful 'Why' to return to when the 'What' has stalled.*

🎯 ACTIVITY

Activity: The Rescue Drill

OBJECTIVE: Recover a 'failed' consultation using the Elephant, Take-Away, or Revisit move

1. Roleplay starts halfway through a consultation that has clearly gone sideways — homeowner is checked ou
2. Rep enters the scene cold — no context except 'this deal is dying'
3. Must identify WHICH rescue technique to use (Elephant, Take-Away, or Revisit) based on what they observ
4. The scene ends when the homeowner either re-engages OR the rep correctly identifies it as a DQ situation
5. Deliverable: A written 'Deal Rescue' script covering all three techniques in order of escalation

35 MIN

MODULE 6.9

Advanced Scenario Training: Neighbors, Media & Fear

Neutralize Misinformation from Outside the Room

MODULE 6.9 — EXTERNAL OBJECTIONS

The Objection That Wasn't Born in the Room

1. The Neighbor Nancy objection: handling hearsay about a bad solar experience
2. Media Myth Busting: science over stories
3. Financial Fear: recession, job loss, and solar as insurance
4. The Myth-Buster cheat sheet for the field folder

The 'Neighbor Nancy' Objection: Handling Hearsay

- 'My neighbor says his solar panels don't work' — the most viral objection in the industry
- Response: ask for specifics before defending: 'Do you know who installed them and when?'
- The distinction: 'Professional solar' vs. 'DIY/cheap solar' is the most important comparison in the industry
- Frame: 'There's a massive difference between a $12,000 budget install and a $35,000 engineered system with a 25-year warranty — your neighbor may have bought the Walmart version'

DIALOGUE

Homeowner:
My neighbor did solar 3 years ago and says his panels barely generate anything.
Rep:
That's really useful information, actually. Do you know what company installed them or what brand panels they used? I ask because there's a real quality divide in this industry — and honestly, the problems your neighbor is describing are almost always associated with budget installs or fly-by-night companies. Let me show you what separates what we do from that situation.

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: 'Neighbor Nancy' objections are uniquely powerful because they come from a trusted source. The rep who argues against the neighbor loses. The rep who agrees that bad solar exists — then pivots to the distinction between cheap and professional — wins.*

Media Myth Buster: Science Over Stories

✗	MYTH: 'Solar causes house fires'	✓	**FACT: Fires are caused by improper DIY installs. Code-compliant professional installs have a near-zero fire incidence rate.**
✗	MYTH: 'Solar doesn't work when it's cloudy'	✓	**FACT: Panels produce 10–25% of peak output on cloudy days. Germany — one of the least sunny nations — is a top solar producer.**
✗	MYTH: 'Solar panels are bad for your roof'	✓	**FACT: Properly installed panels protect the covered section. Most installers guarantee roof penetration for 25 years.**
✗	MYTH: 'Solar companies always go bankrupt'	✓	**FACT: Manufacturer warranties are independent of the installer. Tier-1 panels carry 25-year manufacturer guarantees.**

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Laminate this myth-buster card and keep it in every rep's field folder. When a media myth surfaces, pull out the card, hand it to the homeowner, and read the fact aloud together. Shared reading creates shared belief.*

Financial Fear: Solar as Insurance Against Economic Uncertainty

- The Fear: 'What if I lose my job — will I be stuck with a solar payment I can't afford?'
- The Reframe: 'If you lost your job, would you rather have a $300 bill that keeps rising, or a $160 fixed payment that ends in 10 years?'
- Solar reduces financial exposure to utility volatility — it is a hedge, not a luxury
- 'In an economic downturn, the utility still charges you — and they raise rates. Solar removes that variable from your household budget permanently'

DIALOGUE

Homeowner:
With everything going on economically, I'm just not sure now is the right time.
Rep:
I completely hear that — and I want to show you something that might change the framing. If things get hard economically, the utility bill doesn't pause. In fact, historically, utility rates go UP during economic stress. Solar is the one thing that locks in your energy cost no matter what happens to the economy. It's not a luxury purchase — it's economic protection.

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Financial Fear is particularly common in economic uncertainty periods. The rep who positions solar as a hedge against inflation and job market volatility is selling something every homeowner genuinely needs — regardless of their income level.*

🎯 ACTIVITY

Activity: Myth-Buster Presentation

OBJECTIVE: Debunk a media myth using data in under 60 seconds

1. Trainer assigns each rep a 'Media Myth' from the cheat sheet (or creates a new one)
2. Rep has 60 seconds to: acknowledge the myth as understandable → present the counterevidence → connect it to a financial or safety outcome
3. No reading from notes — must be delivered conversationally
4. Partner grades: Did this feel like facts or propaganda? Was the source credible?
5. Deliverable: A completed 'Myth-Buster' cheat sheet — 6 myths, 6 facts, 6 financial/safety bridges

25 MIN

MODULE 6.10

Day 6 Objection Handling Certification

Master of Objections — Prove It Under Pressure

MODULE 6.10 — CERTIFICATION

The Objection Gauntlet: 5 Objections, 30 Minutes, One Signature

1. 5 specific objections thrown in a live consultation: Smoke Screen, Hostile, Analytical Owl, Neighbor myth, and Think About It at the line
2. Must use ACAC, Isolation, and the Emotional Reset throughout
3. Evaluation on Composure, Framework Accuracy, and Transition Speed
4. The Miller Family AI Final Gauntlet simulation

The Objection Gauntlet: Setup & Certification Rules

🏠 THE MILLER FAMILY

- Husband: retired engineer (Owl) — has another quote from a competitor
- Wife: skeptical — 'heard bad things from a neighbor'
- High bill ($340/mo) but cautious about long-term financial commitments
- Will deploy all 5 objection types — not in order

⚔️ THE 5 GAUNTLET OBJECTIONS

- 1. Smoke Screen: 'We want to talk to our financial advisor'
- 2. Hostile: 'I've seen articles about solar companies scamming people'
- 3. Analytical Owl: Detailed degradation rate + inverter comparison questions
- 4. Neighbor Myth: 'Our neighbor's system barely produces anything'
- 5. Think About It at the line: 'We're 90% there but just need one more day'

📋 CERTIFICATION RULES

- ACAC framework must be visible in every objection response
- No skipping the Cushion — any argumentative tone fails automatically
- Rescue move required if consultation stalls mid-session
- Recording required — manager reviews within 24 hours

✅ PASS CRITERIA

- Score 22/30 on the Evaluation Scorecard
- All 5 objections handled with visible ACAC structure
- No defensive responses — curiosity only
- Consultation ends with a scheduled next step

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: This is the hardest certification in the 7-day program. Reps who pass earn 'Master of Objections' status and advance to Day 7. Reps who score 18–21 get one targeted retry session. Below 18 requires a full Day 6 review.*

Day 6 Certification Scorecard: Master of Objections

1–6 pts	**ACAC Framework Execution**	Was the full sequence visible in every response? Was the Cushion never skipped?
1–6 pts	**Composure Under Hostility**	Did the rep maintain the Late Night DJ voice when challenged aggressively?
1–6 pts	**Objection Isolation Accuracy**	Were Smoke Screens correctly identified and separated from real objections?
1–6 pts	**Deal Rescue Deployment**	Was the Elephant/Take-Away/Revisit used correctly when the consultation stalled?
1–6 pts	**Close Completion**	Did the consultation end with a clear next step — scheduled, confirmed, and on the calendar?

What a 30/30 Performance Looks Like

- The rep treats every objection as information, not as an attack — curiosity is the baseline state throughout
- The Cushion is delivered with genuine warmth — never robotic, never rushed, never skipped
- The rep adjusts in real time: if one technique isn't landing, they pivot — they don't repeat the same approach louder
- The close feels inevitable — like the natural conclusion of a well-facilitated conversation, not a sales event

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: A 30/30 performance is rare. Play recordings from previous exemplary Gauntlet performances if available — let reps hear what mastery in motion sounds like. Elite performance has a feel that words alone cannot fully describe.*

🎯 **ACTIVITY**

AI Simulation: The Miller Family Final Gauntlet

OBJECTIVE: Handle a retired engineer Owl, a skeptical spouse, and a neighbor objection — close on the site survey

45 MIN

1. Scan QR code or click the link to launch the Miller Family AI Simulation bot
2. Mr. Miller (Owl) will demand degradation data, compare your quote to Competitor X, and question inverter specs
3. Mrs. Miller will surface the neighbor objection and a Smoke Screen about their 'financial advisor'
4. Goal: handle all 5 objection types, use ACAC throughout, and close on a scheduled site survey
5. Submit your recording for manager scoring on the Day 6 Evaluation Scorecard

MODULE WRAP-UP

Day 6 Wrap-Up

The Master of Objections Mindset

The 6 Laws of the Day 6 Master of Objections

01 The Cushion Is Non-Negotiable

Never skip the Acknowledge step. An objection argued with is an objection that grows. An objection cushioned is one that deflates.

02 Smoke Before Fire

Never address what they say until you know why they're saying it. The Isolate move separates polite excuses from real fears every time.

03 Agreement Disarms, Defense Escalates

Join the resistance before redirecting it. A rep who agrees with skepticism removes the homeowner's reason to fight.

04 Calm Is a Weapon

Your voice under pressure is the most powerful persuasion tool you own. The Late Night DJ voice closes deals that logic cannot.

05 Name the Wall

Day 6 Self-Assessment: Before You Go to Day 7

- Can I deliver the ACAC framework for any objection without notes — and without skipping the Cushion?
- Can I identify a Smoke Screen within 60 seconds and isolate the real fear using the Magic Wand?
- Can I maintain the Late Night DJ voice when someone tells me solar is a scam — calmly, and without becoming defensive?
- Can I deploy the Deal Rescue toolkit (Elephant, Take-Away, Revisit) when a consultation goes sideways?
- Did I score 22/30 or above on the Gauntlet Scorecard?
- Can I debunk 5 media myths from memory with data and a financial bridge?

📋 *TRAINER NOTE: Day 7 is the final day: referral generation, pipeline management, personal brand, and the rep's long-term identity as a solar professional. Day 6 reps who haven't mastered composure will struggle on Day 7's live field scenarios.*

COMING UP: DAY 7

Long-Term Excellence & The Solar Professional

🤝 Referrals at the Table

Generating 3 warm referrals while the ink is still wet — the system that doubles your pipeline

📊 Pipeline Management

Lead stages, follow-up cadence, and CRM discipline that prevents deals from dying in the dark

🌟 Personal Brand

Building a reputation in your market that makes homeowners call YOU before you knock

🏆 Final Certification

The 7-Day Solar Accelerator Closer Certification — the credential that defines your career